BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE OVERVIEW REPORT

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1. INTRODUCTION

The term Business Intelligence was popularized by Hawed Dresner of the Gartner Group as an umbrella label for concepts and methods that improve decision making though fact based, computerized support systems (Rouhani et al., 2012). In a broad sense, it includes querying, reporting, OLAP (multidimensional analysis), alert tools and business analytics, where business analytics is the statistical, predictive and optimization part of BI (Grossmann and Rinderle-Ma, 2015). In this report Business Intelligence is therefore understood as the process of collecting, organising and analysing business data, and presenting through tools such as dashboards, so that managers can make faster decisions bases on evidence.

2. BUSINESS OBJECTIVE OF THE SUPERSTORE

This project uses the Sample Superstore dataset, which contains retail transaction records covering sales, profits, customer segments, product categories and geographical locations.

i. Main Objective

To analyse Superstore's sales performance and profitability through an interactive Power BI dashboard, identifying key business trends and opportunities for improvement to support informed management decision-making.

3. USE OF DASHBOARDS BY ORGANISATIONS

Organisations use dashboards because they bring key performance measures together on one screen, so managers spend less time reading long, complex reports (Rouhani et al., 2012). According to Eckerson (2005), dashboards also help organisations communicate strategic objectives, improve coordination between departments and ensure employees work towards common goals. They provide a consistent view of business performance, increase visibility and help reduce unnecessary cost and duplication of work.

4. HOW DO DASHBOARDS IMPROVE DECISION-MAKING?

Dashboards improve decision making by presenting complex business information in a visual format that is easier to understand. Yigitbasioglu & Velcu (2012) suggest that dashboard can support decision-making by making use of people’s ability to interpret visual information. They further highlight that dashboards that are well designed can reduce information overload and allow users to explore data at different levels of detail. This enables managers to identify performance issues, examine possible causes and make more informed decisions.

5. CONCLUSION

Business Intelligence helps organisations make informed decisions by transforming raw data into meaningful information. Through the use of interactive dashboards, businesses can monitor performance, identify areas requiring improvement and develop strategies supported by data. The Superstore analysis will demonstrate how Power BI can support these activities through effective data visualisation and reporting.

6. REFERENCES

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